“My needs and feelings never count.”

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Where it often comes from

Teaching about self-denial that left no room for your own needs. A home where your feelings were ignored, dismissed, or punished. Being the caretaker in a struggling family. Hearing “JOY means Jesus first, Others second, Yourself last” as “yourself never.” Fear that having needs is selfish.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus calls us to deny ourselves and love others, but He never taught that our needs and feelings do not matter. He told us to love our neighbor *as ourselves*. Paul said to look not only to your own interests but also to the interests of others, which assumes your own interests count too. God knows you completely, cares for you, and invites you to cast all your anxiety on Him. Jesus Himself rested, ate, wept, and asked His friends to stay with Him.

> *“Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you”* **(1 Peter 5:7)**.

Also see

> “The second is this: ‘Love your neighbor as yourself.’ No other commandment is greater than these” **(Mark 12:31)**.

> “Each of you should look not only to your own interests, but also to the interests of others” **(Philippians 2:4)**.

> “O LORD, You have searched me and known me. You know when I sit and when I rise; You understand my thoughts from afar. You search out my path and my lying down; You are aware of all my ways” **(Psalm 139:1–3)**.

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” **(Galatians 6:2)**.

Common self-statements

- My needs don’t matter.
- It’s selfish to want anything for myself.
- I shouldn’t bother anyone with how I feel.
- Other people always come first.
- If I have needs, I’m being weak.
- God doesn’t care about my feelings.

Common logical errors

- **Discounting yourself:** Treating your needs as less real than everyone else’s.
- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you must either ignore yourself or be selfish.
- **Should statements:** “I shouldn’t need anything.”
- **Mind reading:** Assuming others will see your needs as a burden.

Challenging questions

- What does “love your neighbor as yourself” assume about my own needs?
- Does Philippians 2:4 say to ignore my interests completely?

- Did Jesus have needs and feelings?
- Who taught me that my feelings don't count?
- Can I care for others better if I never care for myself?
- What does 1 Peter 5:7 say God does with my worries?
- What is one need I have been ignoring?

Truth summary

> My needs and feelings count. God knows me fully and cares for me. Jesus Himself had needs and feelings. I can love others and also take reasonable care of myself. I can share my needs, ask for help, and cast all my anxiety on God, because He cares for me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- **Self-Esteem, Low**
- **Love, By God**
- **Help**
- **Self-Sacrifice**
- **Communication**

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My needs and feelings never count"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My needs and feelings never count." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does "as yourself" assume about my needs?
- ☐ Does Paul say to ignore my interests completely?
- ☐ Did Jesus have needs and feelings?
- ☐ Who taught me my feelings don't count?
- ☐ Can I care for others well if I never care for myself?
- ☐ What need have I been ignoring?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My needs and feelings matter to God.
- ☐ God cares for me.
- ☐ I can love others and take care of myself.
- ☐ It is not selfish to have needs.
- ☐ I can ask for help.
- ☐ Others can carry my burdens too.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **1 Peter 5:7**
  "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you."
- [ ] **Mark 12:31**
  "The second is this: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.' No other commandment is greater than these."
- [ ] **Philippians 2:4**
  "Each of you should look not only to your own interests, but also to the interests of others."
- [ ] **Psalm 139:1–3**
  "O LORD, You have searched me and known me. You know when I sit and when I rise; You understand my thoughts from afar. You search out my path and my lying down; You are aware of all my ways."
- [ ] **Galatians 6:2**
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

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Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Needs journal:** Each day, name one thing I felt and one thing I needed, and one small way I honored it.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, 1 Peter 5:7 becomes: "**Sarah** can cast all **her** anxiety on Him, because He cares for **her**."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio download.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Tell one trusted person how you really feel** about something, without minimizing it.
- ☐ **Ask for help with one task this week,** and let them help.
- ☐ **Do one thing to meet a real need,** such as sleep, a meal, or quiet time, without apologizing.
- ☐ **Write a list of needs you've ignored,** and pray over it, asking God to help you care for yourself wisely.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My needs and feelings never count": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One need I honored
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My needs and feelings never count.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that You know me fully and care for me. Help me reject the lie that my needs and feelings never count. Teach me to love others well and to care for myself wisely. Help me bring my needs to You and to others without shame. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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